

LETTER OF RECOMMENDATION

To the Admissions Committee:

I am Zhang Han, Deputy General Manager of the Corporate Banking Headquarters at China Merchants Bank, Dalian Branch, and I am pleased to recommend Jiaxin Xing for graduate programs in AI ethics, AI governance, technology governance, digital humanities, and related interdisciplinary fields.

I first began working with Jiaxin in 2020, during my tenure as Assistant General Manager of the Corporate Banking Headquarters at China Merchants Bank (CMB), Dalian Branch. Through the branch's internal recruitment process, she was selected from a frontline counter operations role to join the Corporate Banking Headquarters, where she assumed primary responsibility for internal control compliance and anti-money laundering (AML) reviews.

At that time, China was experiencing a severe surge in telecommunications and online fraud, and bank accounts had become key conduits for the circulation of illicit funds. This situation exposed an urgent need to upgrade the bank's real-time early-warning mechanisms. Despite being new to her role, Jiaxin did not merely rely on established workflows. Instead, she proactively analyzed the transactional patterns of fraud-related accounts, conducted extensive research, and synthesized recurring behavioral trends. She then translated these empirical findings into transaction risk indicators and collaborated across multiple departments—including Operations Management, Transaction Banking, Legal & Compliance, and Information Technology—to drive the development of a near-real-time suspicious transaction risk control model that was updated daily. In parallel, she reached out to the Head Office to advocate for the implementation of transaction-limit mechanisms and to accelerate the development of a real-time risk control model for high-risk transactions. Throughout this process, I was deeply impressed by her rapid learning agility and, more notably, her capacity to transform unstructured, novel challenges into practical, executable solutions.

During the subsequent EAST data governance initiative mandated by the regional regulatory authority, Jiaxin undertook the meticulous and highly complex task of governing, maintaining, and rectifying legacy corporate client data. Through this work, I gained a fuller appreciation of her diligence, precision, and accountability. She clearly understood that truly effective risk management depends not only on robust models and systems, but equally on the accuracy, integrity, and continuous dynamic upkeep of the underlying data.

Another pivotal stage of her career involved the digital transformation of CMB's corporate banking processes, transitioning from traditional offline approvals to a more streamlined, parallelized online framework. Within a single quarter, she completed necessary training, orchestrated small-scale pilot tests, and successfully managed the full-scale rollout across the Dalian region. During the system implementation, discrepancies in interpretation and execution, along with various unforeseen contingencies, were inevitable. Jiaxin methodically deconstructed these issues, pinpointed accountability at each relevant stage, coordinated with the appropriate stakeholders, and persisted until the new workflows operated stably. This experience convinced me that her capabilities extend beyond risk identification; she possesses the

strategic acumen to translate organizational directives into concrete implementation blueprints and see them through to completion.

In 2021, as downward pressure in China's real estate sector reverberated through the industrial chain into the broader economy, risks related to concentrated credit exposures and rising non-performing assets intensified. Building on her prior work in data governance and information integration, Jiaxin designed a screening model to reorganize the corporate credit client relationship map, while identifying and supplementing information on related controlling entities to complete the credit network. After its launch, this model operated stably for approximately one year. Subsequently, the Head Office dismantled inter-regional information silos to further advance cross-regional group risk management. The relevant Head Office teams adopted and utilized the related-party screening model developed by the Dalian Branch and highly commended the branch for its timely and effective governance work. In my view, this experience directly shaped her later intellectual interest in governance. Its true significance lies not merely in the technical development of a model, but in her ability to synthesize disparate information, organizational protocols, and professional judgment to support more consistent and effective risk-based decision-making.

Beyond these specific projects, Jiaxin also managed routine employee conduct compliance training and communications, regular business inspections, SOP design and optimization for new products, as well as coordination with internal and external audits, remediation efforts, and accountability proceedings. Risk management is inherently reliant on communication and cross-functional cooperation. While firmly enforcing management directives, Jiaxin consistently sustained constructive collaboration across various business units throughout the entire cycle of ex-ante prevention, in-process review, and post-event rectification, thanks to her meticulous nature, patience, and exceptional interpersonal rapport.

In mid-2021, I transferred from the Corporate Banking Headquarters to assume the role of General Manager of a regional operating institution. At this juncture, I was no longer merely her direct supervisor, but a line manager who depended on her for operational business support and risk oversight. Under this new dynamic, I gained an even clearer perspective on how the competencies she cultivated in risk management could deliver tangible value to frontline business management.

After transitioning from risk management to corporate client relationship development and marketing support, Jiaxin began to leverage digital tools and data analytics more extensively to enhance client management. By diagnosing performance gaps within the marketing team and among individual relationship managers, she provided targeted, data-driven coaching and facilitated collaborative marketing initiatives. Concurrently, she provided management teams with ongoing digital analytics dashboards and promoted the adoption of digital tools in day-to-day operations. From my perspective as an end-user, these tools offered unprecedented visibility into our team's operational weaknesses and provided actionable levers for improvement, leading to measurable growth in both the customer base and product allocation efficiency.

Throughout her tenure, Jiaxin consistently demonstrated exceptional initiative, accountability, execution, creativity, and teamwork. These attributes also earned her an "A" rating in the annual performance reviews among her peers for multiple consecutive years.

Jiaxin has since left CMB to pursue further academic enrichment. Meanwhile, I have returned to lead the Corporate Banking Headquarters. Several of the models and management mechanisms she developed or co-established remain in active use within our operations today. As her former supervisor, I was genuinely reluctant to see her depart. However, I was not at all surprised by her decision to pursue advanced studies in AI ethics, AI governance, technology governance, and digital humanities.

In my assessment, her current academic interests do not represent an abrupt pivot, but rather a natural and logical convergence of her human-centric academic grounding and the extensive practical expertise she acquired in data analytics, compliance management, and digital systems. Her unique strength lies in her ability to approach the complex intersections of AI, digital technology, and the humanities from a distinctive vantage point—enriched by firsthand experience in information collection and governance, rule-making for risk control, inter-departmental coordination, data-driven decision-making, and organizational adaptation to new digital ecosystems.

Based on the evidence of her capabilities outlined above, I am delighted to give Jiaxin Xing my strongest and most unreserved recommendation for your graduate program. I look forward with great anticipation to her continued growth and contributions in this exciting new chapter of her academic and professional journey.

Sincerely,



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